

StoryDogs Examples: Grades 3–6

The Volcano That Would Not Stop

Read across each row: the two separate StoryDogs answers become the matching story line. Read down the right column to hear the whole story.

STORYDOGS • TWO ANSWERS	PIXAR RULE #4 + STORYDOGS
WHO? / HERO Character: Eli builds model volcanoes. Struggle: He thinks he must get everything right.	Once upon a time there was Eli, who built model volcanoes and thought he must get everything right.
LIFE / WANT / WISH Life: He rehearses with his science team. Want: Win first prize to prove he is clever.	Every day, he rehearsed with his science team, hoping first prize would prove he was clever.
UH-OH! Change: His foam pump jams at the fair. Decision: Turn it up without telling the team.	One day his foam pump jammed at the fair. He turned it up without telling his team.
TROUBLE Problem: Foam spills through a loose tube. Try: Tape it; the tube sprays sideways.	Because of that, foam spilled through a loose tube. His tape repair sent it spraying sideways.
WORSE! / YIKES! Harder: Foam heads for the team's notes. At risk: Their work and his friends' trust.	Because of that, foam threatened the team's notes. Their work and his friends' trust were at risk.
CLIMAX / SHOWDOWN Challenge: Admit the mistake to his team. Choice: Tell them; together they stop the pump.	Until finally Eli admitted his mistake. Together they stopped the pump and saved the notes.
CHANGE / AFTER! Learned: Owning mistakes helps him learn. End: He tests ideas with his team first.	Ever since then, Eli has owned his mistakes so he can learn. He tests ideas with his team first.

"Ever since then" is a StoryDogs extension, not part of Pixar's original Rule #4.

Ask: How does hiding the mistake increase the trouble? Eli's honest choice helps save the team's work.

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The Great Library Sock Mystery

Read across to match the two StoryDogs answers with their story line. Read down the right column for the whole story.

STORYDOGS • TWO ANSWERS	PIXAR RULE #4 + STORYDOGS
WHO? / HERO Character: Sam loves solving mysteries. Struggle: He jumps to conclusions.	Once upon a time there was Sam, a mystery fan who jumped to conclusions.
LIFE / WANT / WISH Life: He helps at the library craft club. Want: Solve a real case to earn respect.	Every day, he helped at library craft club. He wanted to solve a real case and earn everyone's respect.
UH-OH! Change: Socks vanish from the puppet basket. Decision: Follow a trail of purple fluff.	One day socks vanished from the puppet basket. Sam decided to follow a trail of purple fluff.
TROUBLE Problem: The trail ends at Jo's purple bag. Try: Accuse Jo; she hides her surprise project.	Because of that, Sam found Jo's purple bag and accused her. Jo hid her surprise project.
WORSE! / YIKES! Harder: Jo will not show him the project. At risk: Their friendship and the puppet show.	Because of that, Jo would not show him the project. Their friendship and the puppet show were at risk.
CLIMAX / SHOWDOWN Challenge: Question his own guess. Choice: Apologize and ask; Jo reveals sock puppets.	Until finally Sam questioned his guess, apologized, and asked. Jo revealed the finished sock puppets.
CHANGE / AFTER! Learned: A clue is not the whole answer. End: He asks questions before accusing anyone.	Ever since then, Sam has known that a clue is not the whole answer. He asks questions before accusing anyone.

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Ask: Which clue makes Sam reconsider? A better question solves the mystery and changes Sam's habit.

StoryDogs Examples: Grades 3–6

Captain Crumb's Very Small Rescue

Read across to match the two StoryDogs answers with their story line. Read down the right column for the whole story.

STORYDOGS • TWO ANSWERS	PIXAR RULE #4 + STORYDOGS
WHO? / HERO Character: Crumb is a tiny space captain. Struggle: She thinks only big actions count.	Once upon a time there was Crumb, a tiny space captain who thought only big actions counted.
LIFE / WANT / WISH Life: She delivers lunches around the moon. Want: A heroic rescue to feel important.	Every day, she delivered lunches around the moon. She wanted a heroic rescue to feel important.
UH-OH! Change: A rover gets stuck in a crater. Decision: Pull it out with her lunch ship.	One day a rover got stuck in a crater. Crumb decided to pull it out with her lunch ship.
TROUBLE Problem: The rover is too heavy. Try: Pull harder; the ship sinks into moon dust.	Because of that, she pulled harder at the heavy rover. Her ship sank into moon dust.
WORSE! / YIKES! Harder: Both vehicles are stuck. At risk: The crew's ride home and their lunches.	Because of that, both vehicles were stuck. The crew might lose their ride home and their lunches.
CLIMAX / SHOWDOWN Challenge: Try something smaller. Choice: Put lunch trays under wheels; both roll free.	Until finally Crumb tried a smaller idea. She put lunch trays under the wheels, and both vehicles rolled free.
CHANGE / AFTER! Learned: Small ideas can make a big difference. End: She proudly delivers lunches—and spare trays.	Ever since then, Crumb has valued small ideas. She proudly delivers lunches—and spare trays.

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Ask: Why does the big solution fail? Crumb's small solution succeeds when she changes her idea of bravery.